Karen Podier – SQL Final Project
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WORLD HAPPINESS PROJECT

PROJECT OVERVIEW

This project analyses global happiness using SQL. The aim is to explore key patterns and identify the key factors that influence happiness levels across countries.

The analysis focuses on:

- The top and bottom 10 happiest countries
- The average global happiness score
- Key drivers of happiness, including social support and healthy life expectancy

These insights aim to provide a clearer understanding of what contributes to national wellbeing.

DATASET OVERVIEW

This dataset contains global happiness data for 156 countries in 2019, including key variables used to measure and explain happiness levels across nations.

Key variables include:

- Happiness score (average score 5.41)
- GDP per capita (average score 0.91)
- Social support (average score 1.21)
- Healthy life expectancy (average score 0.73)
- Generosity (average score 0.19)
- Perceptions of corruption (average score 0.11)

This dataset enables the analysis of patterns and identification of key factors influencing happiness across countries.

GLOBAL HAPPINESS RANKINGS

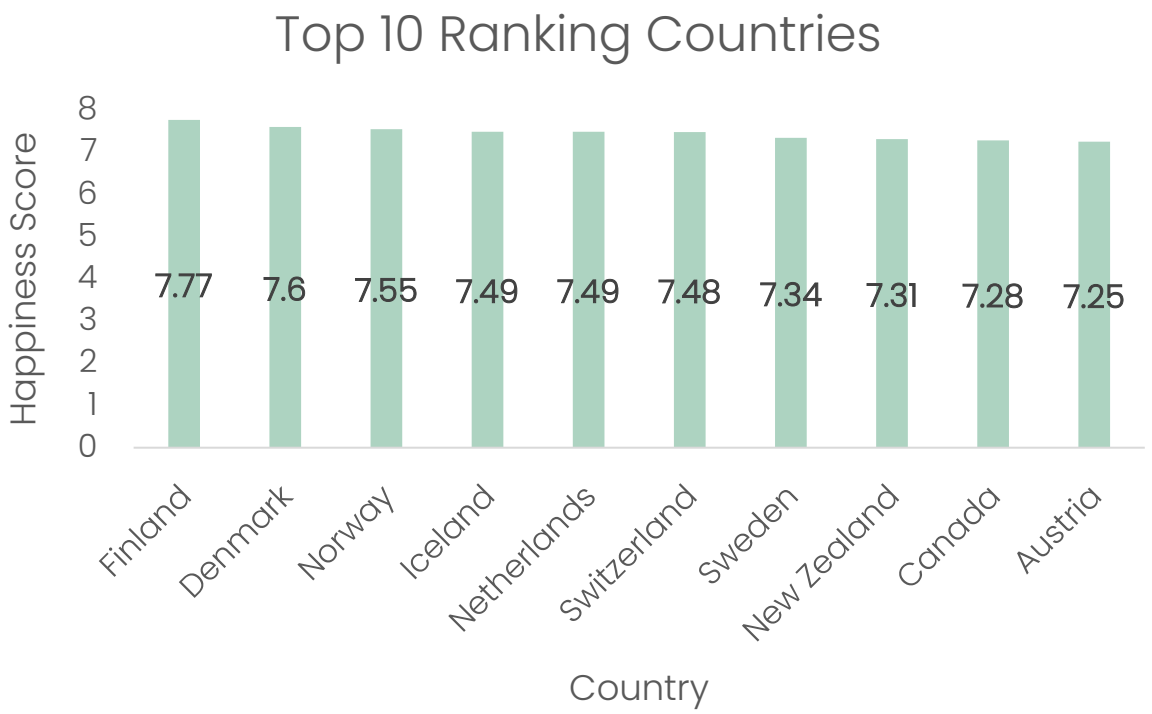
COUNTRY	HAPPINESS SCORE
Finland	7.77
Denmark	7.6
Norway	7.55
Iceland	7.49
Netherlands	7.49
Switzerland	7.48
Sweden	7.34
New Zealand	7.31
Canada	7.28
Austria	7.25

Full dataset includes 156 countries ranked by happiness score (descending). Top 10 shown for clarity.

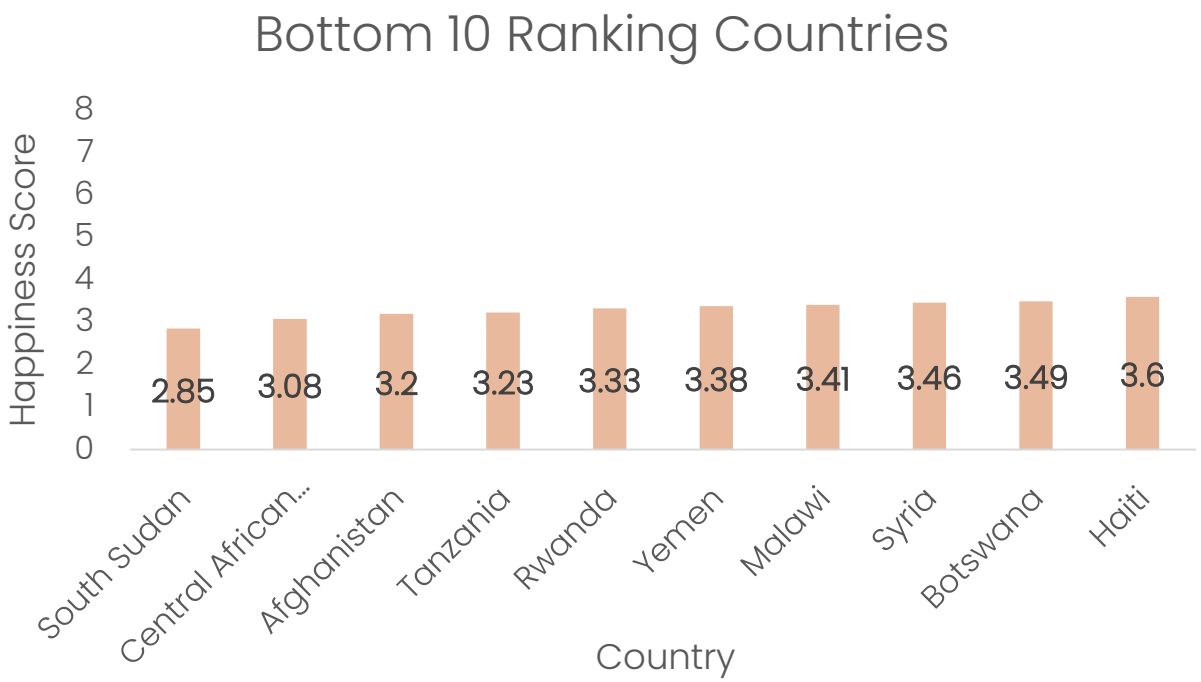
The highest-ranking countries are predominantly located in Europe, particularly Nordic regions. These top-ranking countries consistently score above 7.2, indicating high levels of overall wellbeing.

TOP VS BOTTOM HAPPINESS RANKINGS

The highest-ranking country is Finland, followed by Denmark and Norway, suggesting strong social support systems and high levels of wellbeing.



The lowest-ranking country is South Sudan, followed by Central African Republic and Afghanistan, suggesting weaker social and economic conditions contributing to lower wellbeing.



There is a significant gap between the highest and lowest ranking countries, highlighting inequality in global wellbeing

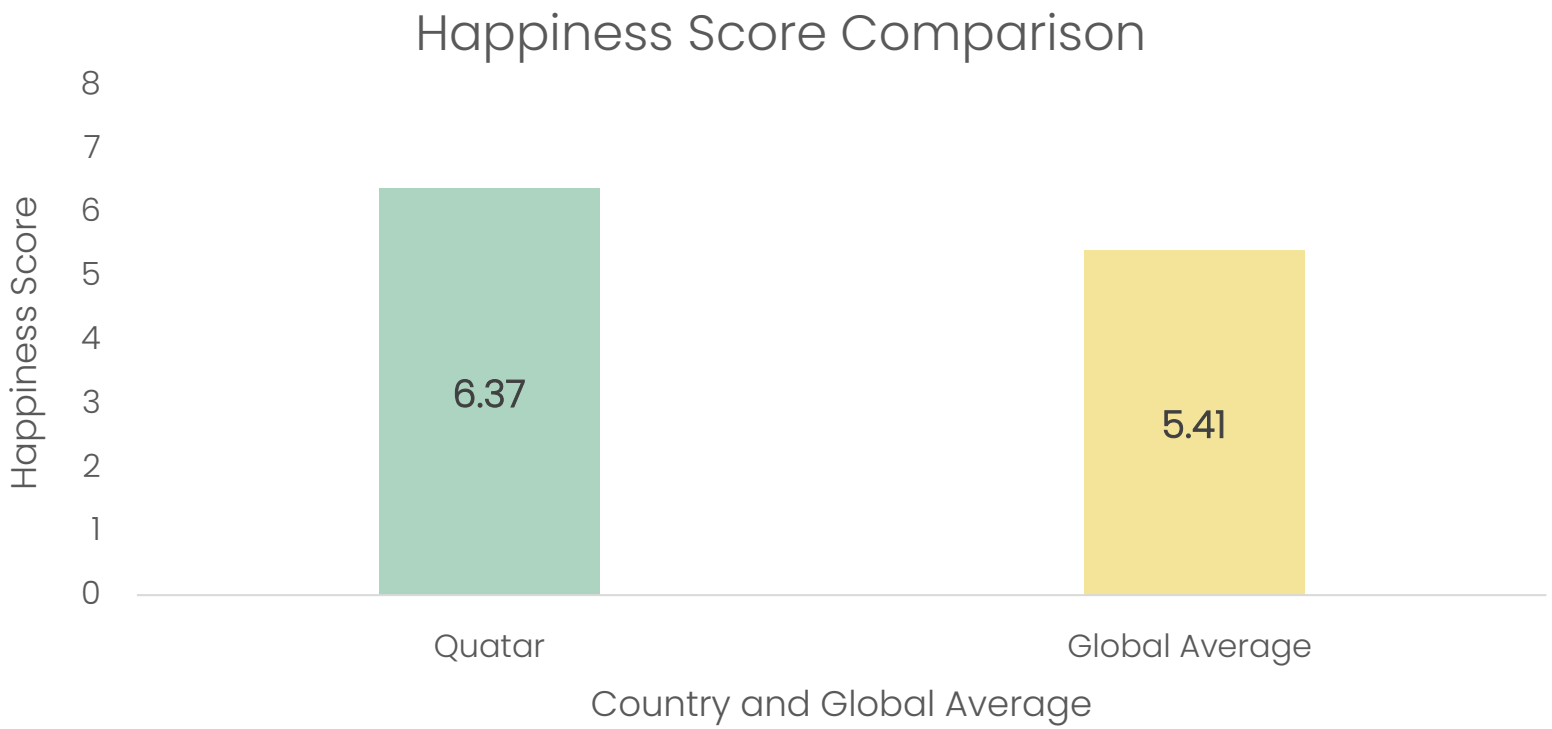
5.41

Average Happiness Score

The global average happiness score of 5.41 suggests moderate wellbeing across countries, reinforcing the gap observed between the highest and lowest ranking countries

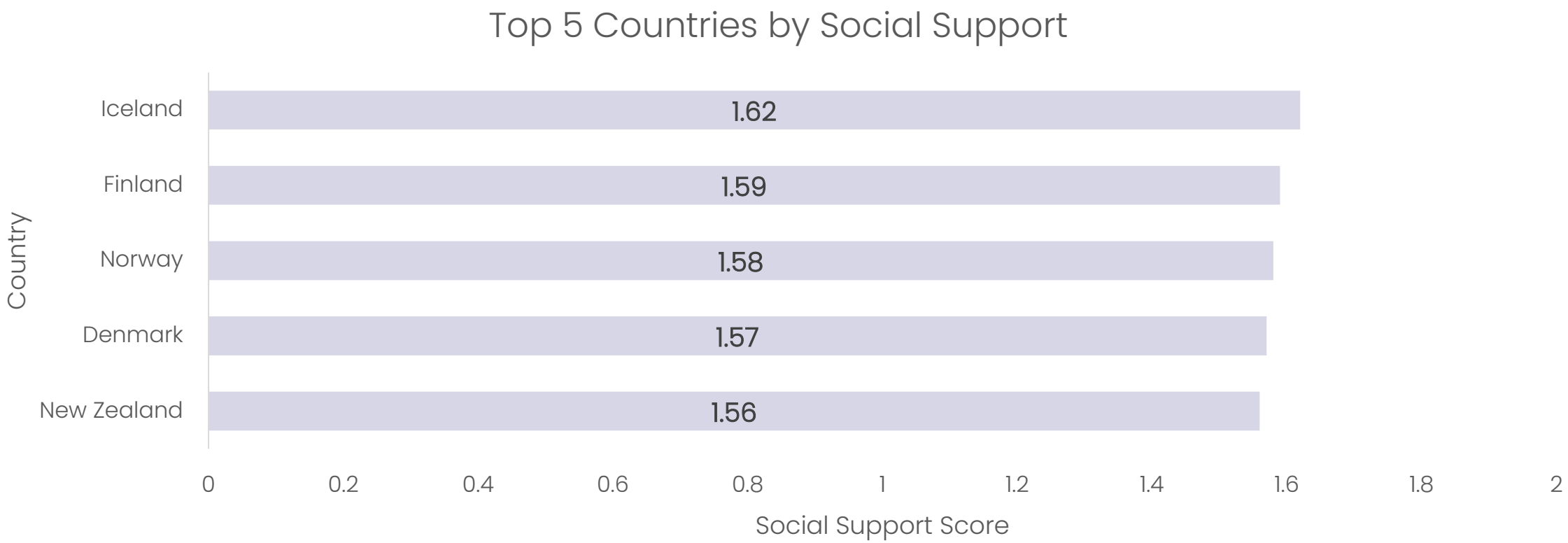
GDP per CAPTIA vs HAPPINESS

Qatar has the highest GDP per capita in the dataset.



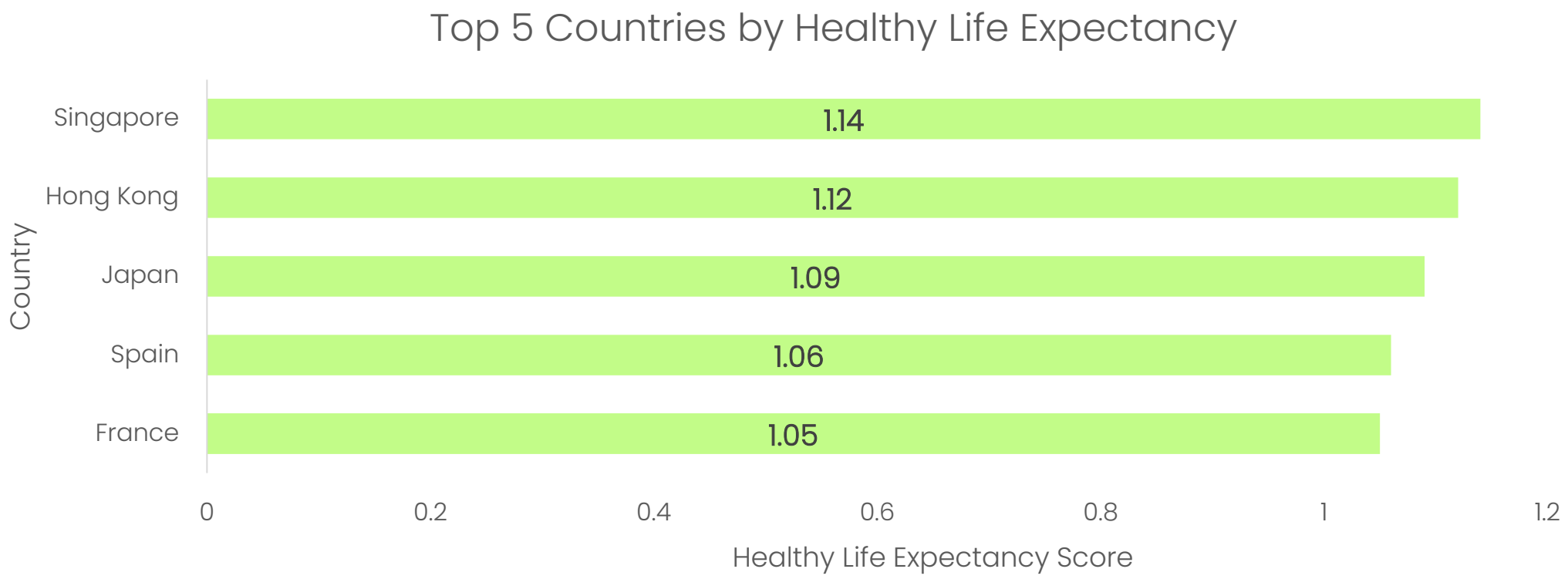
Despite having the highest GDP per capita, Qatar's happiness score is only slightly above the global average, suggesting that wealth alone does not determine happiness.

SOCIAL SUPPORT



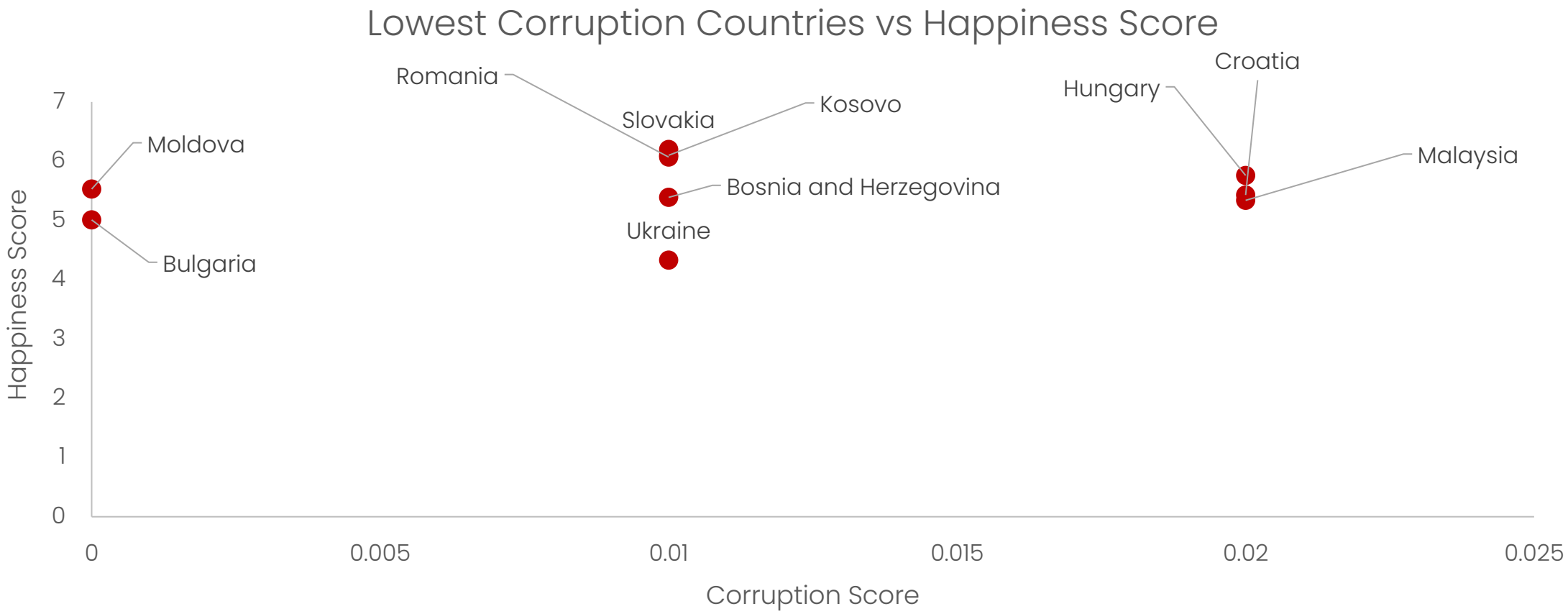
Countries with the highest levels of social support are predominantly Nordic, and these countries also rank highly in overall happiness, suggesting a strong relationship between social support and wellbeing.

HEALTHY LIFE EXPECTANCY



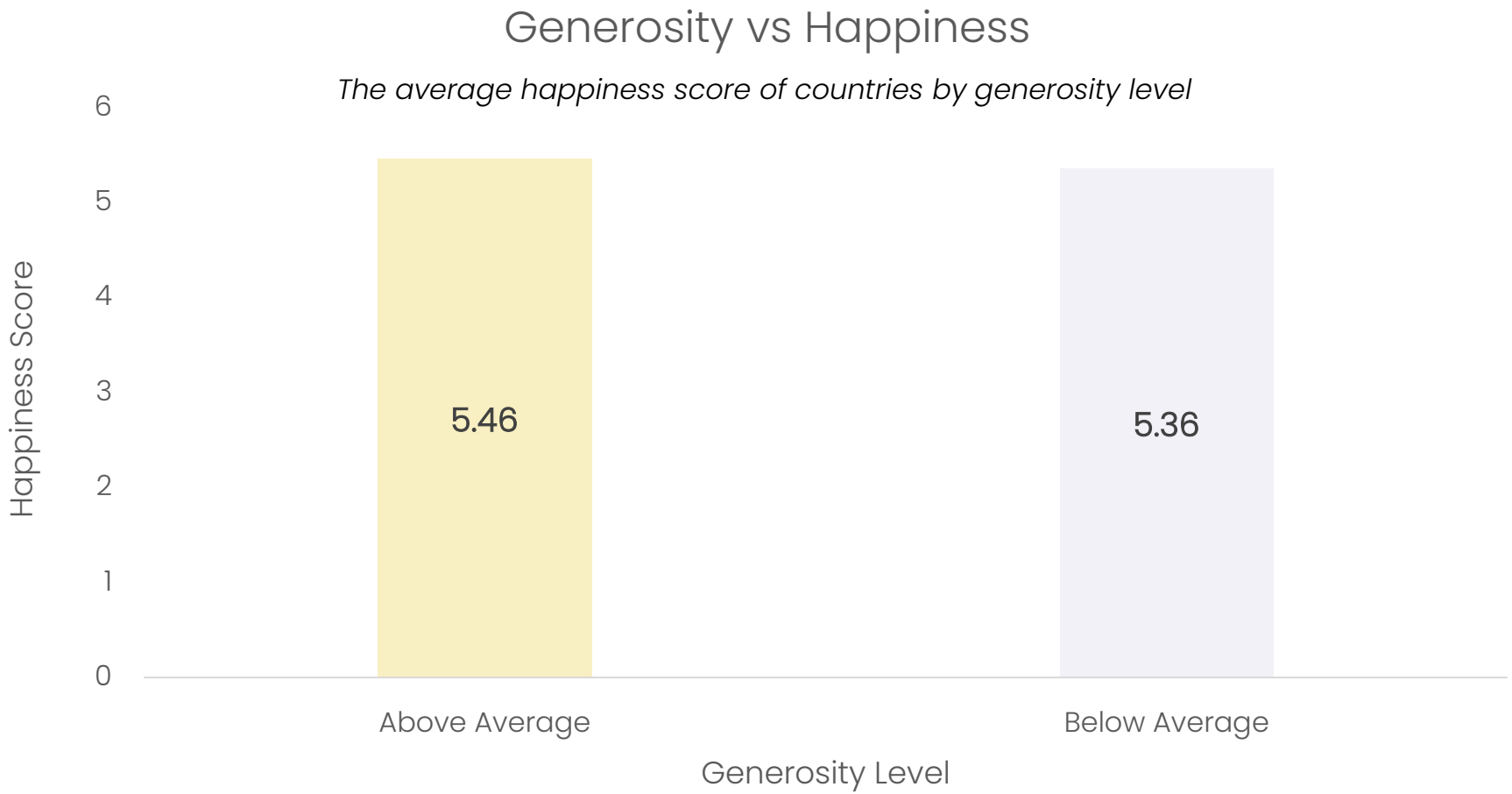
Countries with the highest healthy life expectancy tend to have strong healthcare systems and high living standards, they also rank highly in happiness, suggesting that health is a key contributor to overall wellbeing.

CORRUPTION VS HAPPINESS



Countries with lower levels of corruption generally show higher happiness scores, suggesting that trust in institutions and governance plays an important role in overall wellbeing.

GENEROSITY AND HAPPINESS



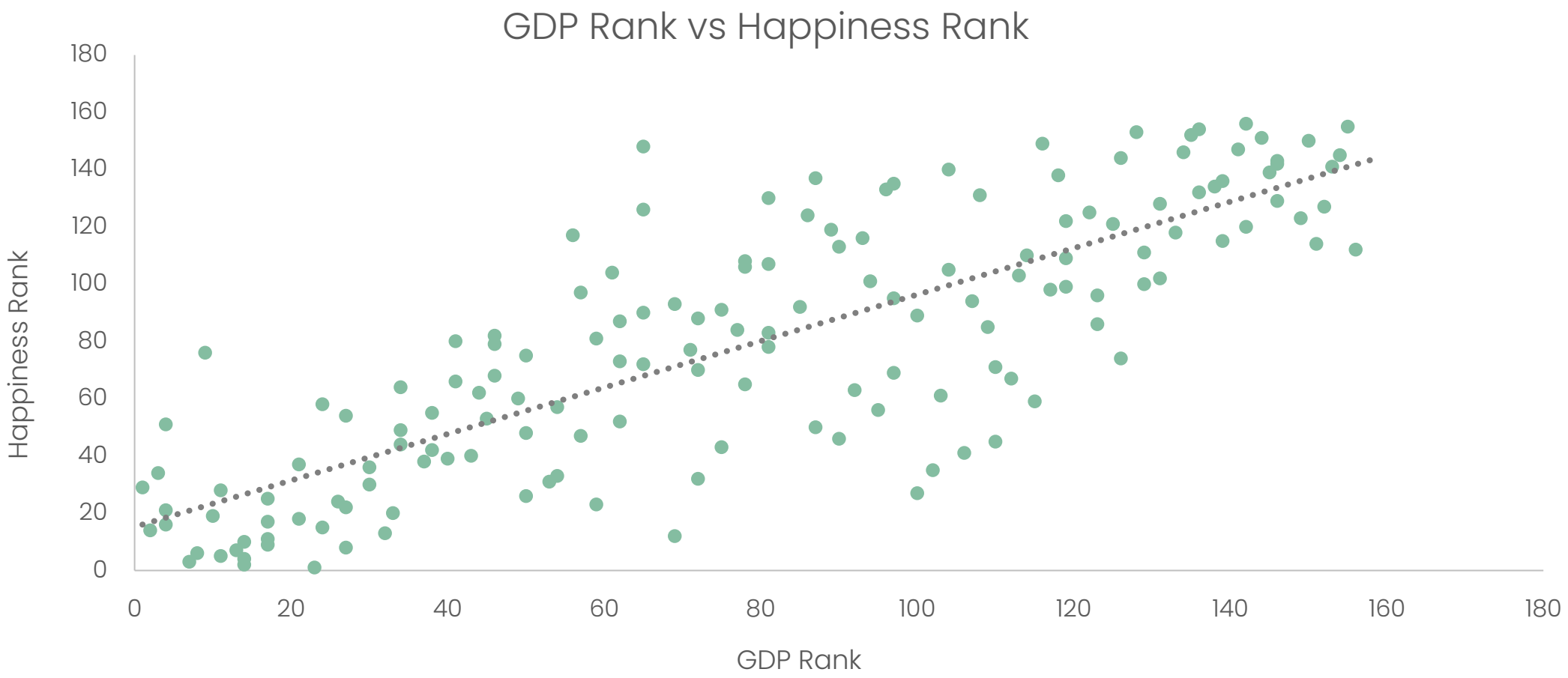
Countries with higher generosity levels show only a small increase in happiness scores, suggesting that generosity has a limited impact on overall wellbeing compared to other factors.

OUTLIERS IN HAPPINESS RANKING

Country	Happiness Rank	GDP rank	Rank Difference
Botswana	148	65	83
Guatemala	27	100	73
El Salvador	35	102	67
Hong Kong	76	9	67
Nicaragua	45	110	65
Uzbekistan	41	106	65
Iran	117	56	61
Iraq	126	65	61
Costa Rica	12	69	57
Honduras	59	115	56

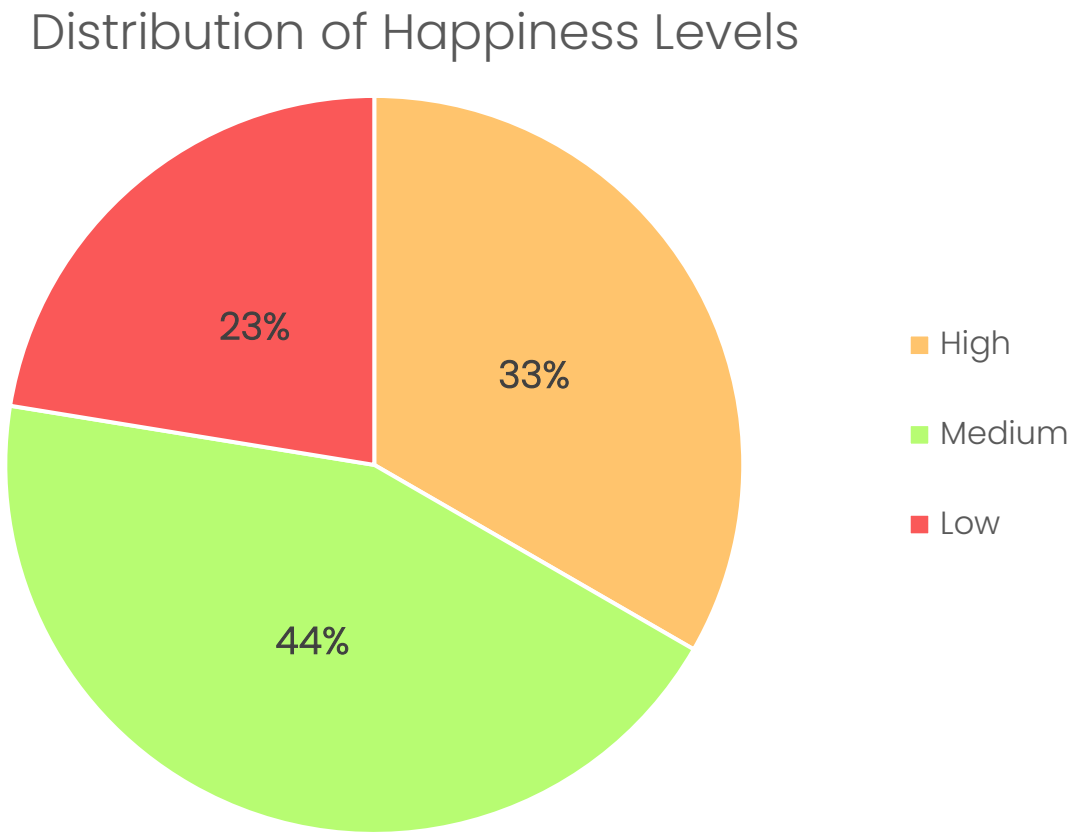
Several countries exhibit significant differences between GDP rank and happiness rank, highlighting that economic wealth does not always translate into higher levels of wellbeing. For example, Costa Rica ranks much higher in happiness than its GDP rank suggests, while Hong Kong shows the opposite trend.

GDP PER CAPITA VS HAPPINESS



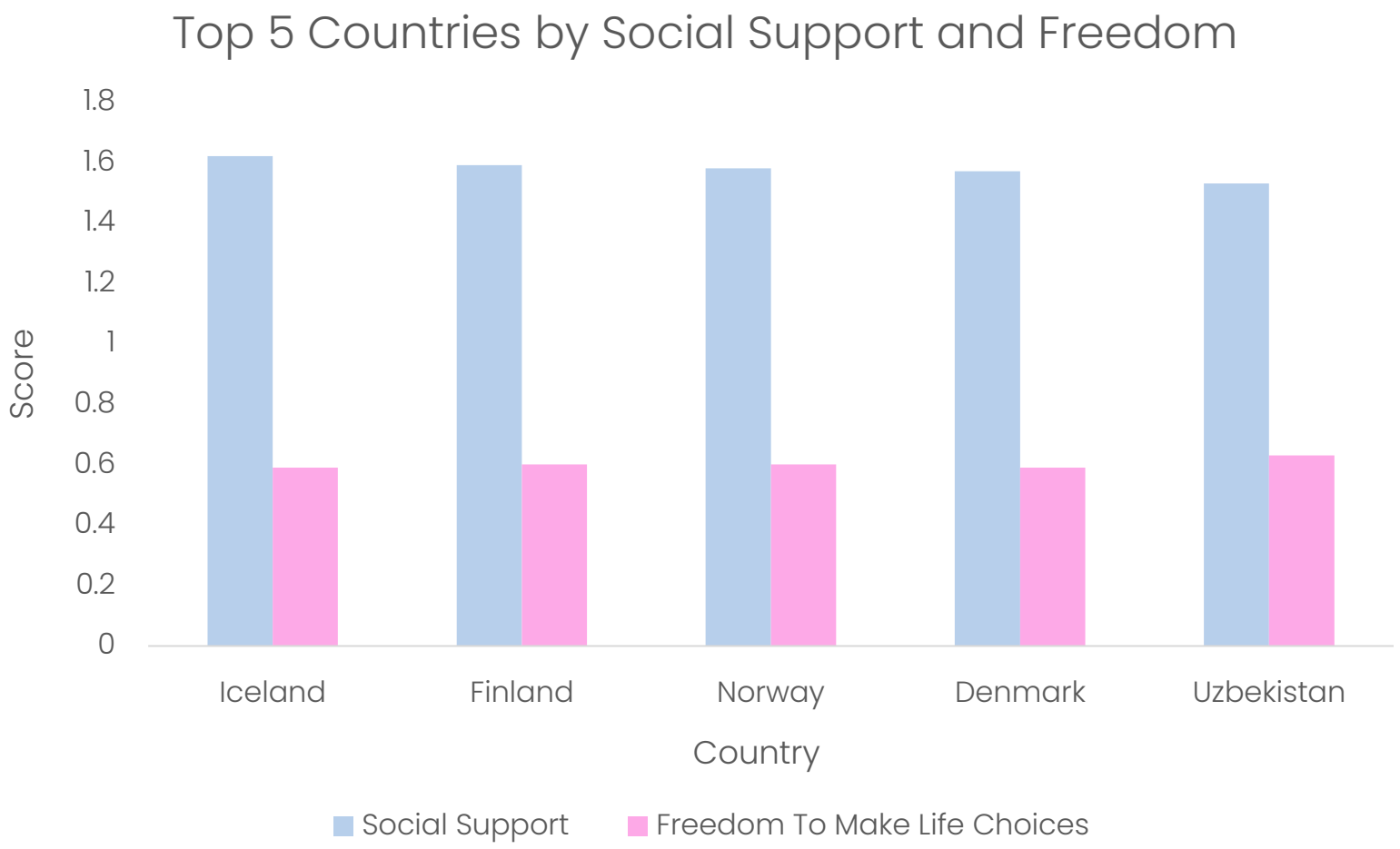
There is a general positive correlation between GDP rank and happiness rank, but several outliers suggest that wealth alone does not fully determine happiness.

HAPPINESS GROUPS



The majority of countries fall within the medium happiness range, which suggests globally there are moderate levels of happiness. Fewer countries in the high and low categories suggest than extreme happiness levels are less common.

SOCIAL SUPPORT AND FREEDOM



Countries with the highest levels of social support also tend to have high levels of freedom, indicating a positive relationship between strong social systems and individual autonomy.

KEY FINDINGS

- The average global happiness score is 5.41, indicating moderate levels of wellbeing across countries.
- Economic wealth alone is not a strong predictor of happiness, as several high-GDP countries rank lower in happiness than expected.
- Social support and healthy life expectancy are key drivers of happiness, showing strong positive relationships with overall wellbeing.
- Lower levels of corruption are associated with higher happiness, highlighting the importance of trust and effective governance.

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

To improve national wellbeing, policymakers should prioritize **investment in social support systems and healthcare**, as these show the strongest relationships with happiness.

Efforts to **reduce corruption** are also essential, as trust in institutions plays a key role in overall wellbeing.

Finally, governments should adopt a more **holistic approach** to development by focusing not only on economic growth, but also on factors that directly impact quality of life.